

DATA201: Data Communication and Ethics

Professor Dr. Aye Hninn Khine

Report:

“My Beloved BaBa”

Kyaw Toe Toe Han

14.05.2026

My Beloved BaBa

Story Description:

BaBa was the husband of my grandmother's sister. He lived just next door to my home in a small village in Myanmar. He was not my grandfather by blood. But he was the one who took care of me when things were hard at home. Every morning, BaBa woke up before me. He boiled water and made my favorite breakfast, Mont T Thoke, with plain tea or coffee. When I was hurt or in trouble, I ran to his house. He put medicine on my wounds. He let me sleep at his house when I needed safety. He gave me his own clothes when mine were dirty. He told me stories at night about life and the world.

When I was 15, I moved to Monywa for high school. Then at 18, I moved to Mandalay for university. I visited BaBa less and less each year. I kept telling myself I would visit soon. In late 2019, I planned to bring him a bottle of good liquor after my exams. I never did. In November 2020, BaBa had a sudden stroke. He passed away at age 72. I was in my fourth year of university. I had visited him only twice that year.

This project turns those 27 years of memories into data. The goal is not to make loss feel cold. The goal is to see the patterns that grief alone cannot show clearly.

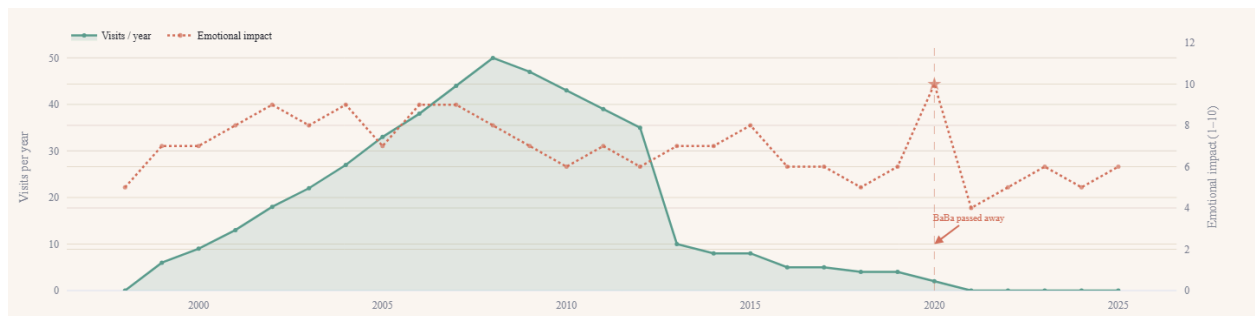
Key Findings:

The dataset covers 28 records across 27 years, from birth in 1998 to 2025. Each row is one year of life. The main variables are visit frequency, relationship closeness, emotional impact score, life stage, and memory category.

Visit frequency over time

As a toddler, I could not visit BaBa on my own. Visits grew as I got older and more independent. They peaked at 50 times a year when I was 10. After I left home at 15, they fell sharply. By university, I averaged 4 visits a year. In 2020, BaBa's last year, I visited only twice.

The chart below shows this. The visit line rises through childhood, then drops after 2013. The fall is gradual at first, then steep. No single year felt like a final goodbye.



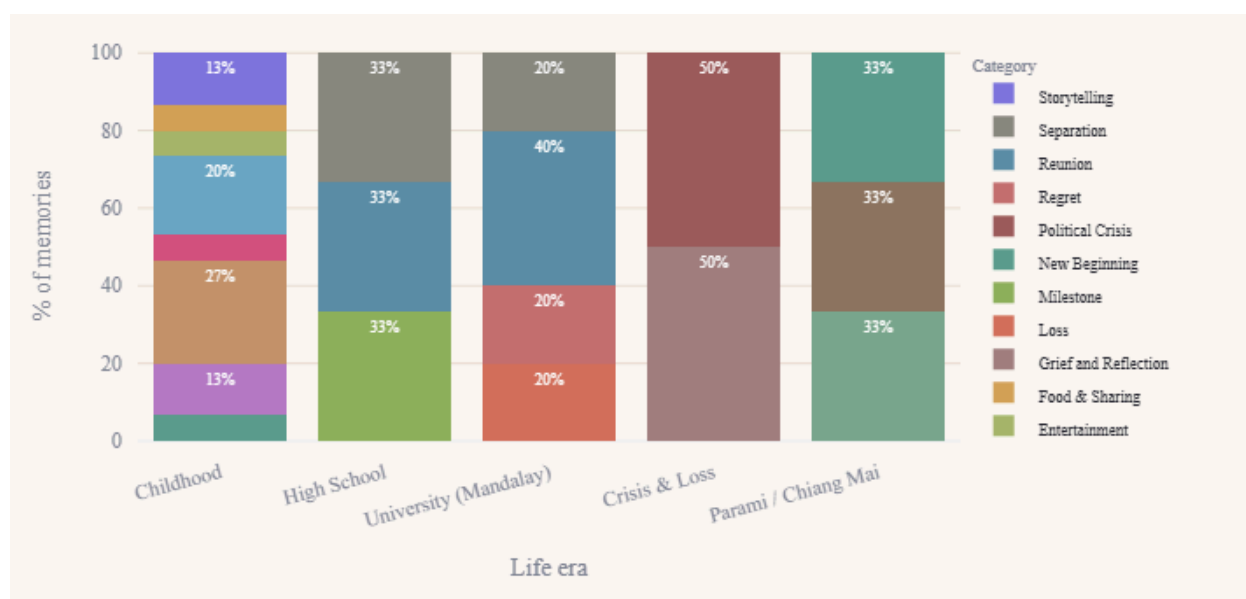
Visits and closeness do not always match

The scatter chart plots each year as a dot. The x-axis shows visits per year. The y-axis shows relationship closeness score. Most dots follow the pattern: more visits, more closeness. But 2020 is an outlier. That year I visited only twice, yet closeness scored 10 out of 10 — the highest in the whole dataset. Being physically present helped build closeness, but it was not the only thing that mattered.



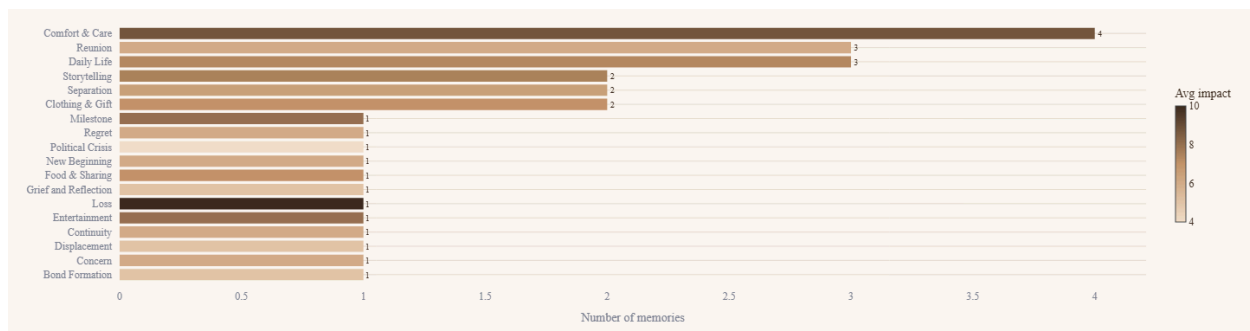
The relationship narrowed in kind, not just in frequency

The stacked bar chart shows memory categories by life era. In childhood, memories cover 7 types: Comfort and Care, Daily Life, Storytelling, Food and Sharing, Clothing and Gift, Entertainment, and Concern. By university, the bars thin down to mostly Separation and Reunion. I was not only visiting less. The texture of what we shared had already faded before he did.



Comfort and Care are the most remembered memory

Comfort and care are the most common memory type, with 4 records. Three of those score 9/10. BaBa was the person I went to when I was hurt or in trouble. No other memory type shows up that often or that strongly. This means that whenever I was sad, hurt, or in trouble, BaBa was the person I ran to for help and love. The memories of him making me feel safe happened the most often and were the most important to me.



Decision Making:

The data raises one clear question. I still felt close to BaBa even when I rarely visited. So why did I not visit more? The answer is not in the data. But the data shows what the cost was.

Decision 1: Set fixed dates to visit people I love

Visits dropped 96% from age 10 to BaBa's last year. During university, I averaged 4 visits per year. Each time, I told myself I would go soon. The scatter chart shows that visits did produce closeness in most years. But in 2020, there were only 2 visits left. I will not leave visits as open plans. I will put them in the calendar as fixed dates.

Decision 2: Do the kind thing now, not later

2019 is the only year in 27 years of data tagged as Regret. I had a simple plan: bring BaBa a bottle of good liquor after my exams. I did not do it. His health that year was recorded as healthy

before his stroke. There was no warning. I learned that there is no safety later. If I want to do something kind, I should do it now.

Decision 3: Keep the relationship varied, not just frequent

By my university years, almost all memories with BaBa were only Separation and Reunion. The stacked bar chart makes this visible. The relationship had become thin. When I cannot visit, I will still try to share something real: a story, a question, a memory. That is what kept us close even in 2020 with only 2 visits.

Limitations of these decisions

- This is one relationship across 28 data points. These patterns may not apply to others.
- Visit counts for early childhood are estimates from memory. They are not exact.
- Emotional and closeness scores were given in 2025, looking back. Knowing BaBa passed away likely affected earlier scores.
- Some years I could not visit more due to the Myanmar coup, displacement, and limited money. The data does not show those barriers.

Ethical Discussion:

Privacy

I did not use real full names in this dataset. BaBa is a family term. Grandma Cho is referred to by a common name only. No addresses, ID numbers, or private records are included. All scores were created by me and reflect only my own memories.

Bias and limitations

All data comes from personal memory. Early years may be idealized because they were the happiest. The dataset has only 28 rows. Emotional impact and closeness scores are subjective. They are my feelings, not objective measurements. I knew how the story ended. So, it certainly made me score certain years higher or lower than I would have at the time.

Why I chose each visualization

The dual-axis line chart shows visits and emotional impact together over time. Both axes are labeled clearly to avoid confusing the two scales. The scatter chart tests one direct question: does visiting more mean feeling closer? It makes the answer visual without using words. The 2020 dot tells the story on its own. The stacked 100% bar chart is normalized so each bar is the same height. This removes the distortion of unequal record counts per era and puts the focus on proportion, not volume. The ranked bar chart shows which memory types appear most and uses color to add emotional weight as a second variable without a second axis.

Responsible use

The decisions in this report are personal reflections. They are not advice for others. I do not claim these patterns apply to every relationship. Outside events like the Myanmar military coup and displacement limited my choices in ways the data cannot fully show. No one else's private data is used or shared here. This project is an academic exercise only.